

# Brock Whitbread-Cole

## Full Stack Software Engineer

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### Summary

I'm a Full Stack Engineer with 5 years of experience building exceptional web experiences and 2.5 years of experience teaching others to do the same. I strive to write code that solves problems in a clean and readable way. Apart from coding, my strongest asset is communication; I always do my best to communicate clearly, openly, and with a little humour. I am passionate about deliberately practicing and developing my skills both in and out of the code editor.

### Skills

These are the hard and soft skills I use every day to help make the web a better place:

#### Code

- In my career I have had the opportunity to learn, use, and teach many different technology stacks. Much of my recent work experience has revolved around writing **Full Stack web apps** and **APIs** using **Node** or **Python**.
- Most of my database experience has been with **PostgreSQL** but I am also comfortable with and frequently use **MongoDB**.
- On the Front End, I have recent experience using and teaching **React**. I enjoy building apps with **React** but would not be where I am now without more traditional Front End experience using and teaching **HTML**, **CSS**, and **Javascript**.
- Recently, through the **Computer Science** degree program I am taking at University of Colorado, Boulder, I am learning **C++**.

#### Not Code

- I've worked in environments practicing **small-a agile development**. I'm comfortable presenting work in front of a group and updating the team on my progress.
- **Teamwork makes the dreamwork** and, whether with a coworker or student, I do my best to keep lines of communication open, comfortable, and collaborative.
- **I work well on my own** and I highly value the opportunity to work from home.
- I have a good sense of humour and I try to be positive, even when life gets stressful.

- At home I'm usually tinkering or trying to learn a new skill (bonsai tree development is the current one). I also read quite a lot and for two years running I've completed the National Novel Writing Month challenge writing 50,000 words in 30 days.

## Work Experiences

Lead Instructor, Software Engineering Immersive

General Assembly | San Francisco, CA and Remote | August 2018 to April 2021

**Skills Used:** Express, Javascript, Django, Flask, Python, HTML, CSS, AWS, git, Writing and Delivering Lesson Content, Mentoring, Leadership, Code debugging.

**Role Overview:** General Assembly is one of the world's leading immersive education providers and, as a Lead Instructor, I was responsible for teaching classes of 20-30 students the fundamentals of full stack web development and computer science. Feedback for my teaching was consistently positive but I am most proud of having the opportunity to teach students in the Adobe Digital Academy Scholarship Program which attempts to support and place candidates from underrepresented backgrounds into roles at Adobe. I also served on the Product Advisory Board and was a member of the Distinguished Faculty Program reserved for top teaching talent at the company.

Senior Front End/Full Stack Web Developer

Hashtag Paid, Inc. | Toronto, Canada | Mar 2016 to July 2017

**Skills Used:** Ruby on Rails, JavaScript, CSS3/SASS, HTML5, elasticsearch, Gulp, AWS, Test suite building, git, (light) Agile Methodologies.

**Role Overview:** Hashtag Paid pairs Influencers with Brands and I led development on their onboarding experiences for both groups of users, I refactored or rebuilt much of the front end architecture, and, as a result of being on such a small team, I was regularly tasked with backend assignments as needed. In this role I became more comfortable in a full stack role and loved seeing the full picture of building features that spanned the whole stack. I'm most proud of my work on their Campaign Manager product which took a variety of Brand-provided data and selected our best Influencers as potential collaborators.

## Web Development Instructor (Part-Time)

Bitmaker Labs/General Assembly Toronto | Toronto, Canada | Jan 2016 to July 2017

**Skills Used:** Teaching, Collaboration, Presenting to Groups, Ruby on Rails, JavaScript, CSS3/SASS, HTML5.

**Role Overview:** I occasionally lectured in the mornings (usually on front end and Javascript-based topics) but most of the time I served as a support instructor. Sometimes that meant one-on-one work with a student, leading a breakout for a small group, or gathering the whole class together to rehash a particular topic together. I felt as though I learned as much as the students I taught and it was rewarding to give back to my community.

## Front End Web Developer

Filament Creative, Inc. | Toronto, Canada | May 2014 to Mar 2016

**Skills Used:** CSS3/SASS, HTML5, jQuery, Wordpress, git, light Agile methodologies.

**Role Overview:** I worked on the development team building marketing websites for a wide variety of clients. I had the chance to help at all stages of development from sketching and planning, prototyping, and coding. I worked one-on-one with a client to guide them through a development roadmap, learned to manage expectations and how to keep a client relationship positive in the midst of a changing project.

## Education

University of Colorado, Boulder (Part-Time)

**Post-Baccalaureate BSc, Computer Science** | Sept 2020 - Present

Bitmaker Labs

**Immersive Web Development Course** | March 2014 - May 2014

Willfrid Laurier University

**BA, Journalism & Contemporary Studies** | September 2007 - June 2011